

Heuristic scanning is supported, and hence newer viruses that might not be listed in the virus database can also be detected. You can specify the action to be taken when a virus is detected, such as whether the file should be deleted or quarantined or a user intervention be requested. It puts a significant load on the processor while scanning, it logged 44.25 per cent usage which is quite high; you may be unable to work while scanning is in progress.

Though it was not the fastest scanner, it wasn't too slow either; the test scan took 323 seconds, a little over five minutes.

BitDefender sported a commendable lowest average outbreak response time of between 2 and 4 hours, which leaves the system vulnerable for very little time.

There is no telephone support, but there is Live! Support, which lets you chat online with experts to try and find a fix for your problem.

Web site: www.bitdefender.com

Minimum System Requirements: Windows 9x/ME/XP/NT/2000, 64 MB RAM, 40 MB hard drive space

3.2.3 Paid Anti-virus Software

Why would you want to pay for anti-virus software when you can get it for free? The short answer is simple—added functionality, and the permission to use it in a commercial setup. Paid anti-virus packages are usually complete security suites. As for the long answer, you'll have to read on to find out. Here, we take a look at some well-known and trusted anti-virus suites.

3.2.3.1 eScan Internet Security 2006

MicroWorld Technologies, Inc.'s eScan Internet Security Suite 2006 is a complete security suite that is based on MWL technology. MWL or MicroWorld WinSock Layer is a concept that allows for scanning Internet traffic in real-time.